A Fan Replays 'Kingdom Hearts' and Misses Final Fantasy Friends

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The video game website Kotaku is **replaying** the whole 'Kingdom Hearts' **series** over one year. The next big game, 'Kingdom Hearts IV,' is expected in about a year.

'Kingdom Hearts' mixes Disney characters, like Donald Duck and Goofy, with heroes from the 'Final Fantasy' games. The main hero is a boy named Sora.

In a new post, a writer looks back at the first game. As a kid, the writer did not know some characters came from 'Final Fantasy.' Now they notice a lot more.

On Sora's home, Destiny Islands, his friends Tidus, Wakka and Selphie are younger than in their own games. They use playground **versions** of their **weapons**. Tidus has a wooden practice sword, and Selphie swings a jump rope!

The writer says 'Final Fantasy' characters show up less and less in later games. They wonder if newer 'Final Fantasy' heroes might appear in 'Kingdom Hearts IV.'

Word Treasure

replaying -- Playing a game again from the start.
versions -- Different forms of the same thing.
weapons -- Tools used for fighting, like swords.
series -- A set of games, books or shows that go together.

Background you need

'Kingdom Hearts' is a video game where players visit worlds from Disney movies.

It also includes heroes from another game series called 'Final Fantasy.'

Break it down

WHO: A writer at the video game website Kotaku
WHAT: A look back at how the first 'Kingdom Hearts' used 'Final Fantasy' characters
WHERE: Sora's home of Destiny Islands and other game worlds
WHY: Kotaku is replaying the series before 'Kingdom Hearts IV' comes out

Why it matters

Kids who play games can think about which characters make a crossover game fun.

Test what you remember

1. Which website is replaying 'Kingdom Hearts'?

- (A) FlixPatrol
- (B) Kotaku
- (C) NASA
- (D) Disney+

2. Who is the main hero of 'Kingdom Hearts'?

- (A) Sora
- (B) Tidus
- (C) Max
- (D) Goofy

3. Which Disney characters are in the game?

- (A) Woody and Buzz
- (B) Elsa and Anna
- (C) Donald Duck and Goofy
- (D) Moana and Maui

4. What does Tidus use as a weapon on Destiny Islands?

- (A) A bow
- (B) A wooden practice sword
- (C) A hammer
- (D) A jump rope

5. What game is expected in about a year?

- (A) 'Hocus Pocus 3'
- (B) 'Final Fantasy I'
- (C) 'Kingdom Hearts IV'
- (D) 'VisionQuest'

6. What does the writer wish for?

- (A) More 'Final Fantasy' characters in the games
- (B) No more Disney characters
- (C) Harder puzzles
- (D) Shorter games

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: C 4: B 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Kotaku writer: Wishes the games had more 'Final Fantasy' characters again.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):